Progress Christian Centre

Connect Hub

Complete User Guide

Finance & Student Management Portal

Version 2026.05 - All Portals: Admin, Staff, Teacher, Student, Owner

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1. Getting Started & Login

Progress Christian Centre Connect Hub is the official finance and student management portal. It serves Administrators, Cashiers, Timetable Managers, Teachers, Students and the Owner from a single secure web app.

Accessing the System

- Open the portal URL in any modern browser (Chrome, Edge, Safari, Firefox).
- The login screen offers two modes: Student login (registration number) and Admin/Staff login (name selector).
- Sessions are kept secure; idle sessions are timed out automatically for sensitive areas.

Logging In

Students

- Enter your 6-character registration number (e.g. K0023T).
- Enter the password you created during account setup.
- Click Sign In to enter the Student Portal.

Staff / Admin

- Click 'Admin / Staff Login' on the login card.
- Select your name from the dropdown (list is fetched live from the server).
- Enter your password and sign in. You will be routed to your role's landing page.

If you forget your password, contact the system administrator. Passwords cannot be reset by students themselves for security reasons.

2. Account Setup (Students)

New students must claim their account before logging in. Registration numbers are pre-loaded by the school and mapped internally to a virtual email (REGNUMBER@pcc.local).

Claiming Your Account

- From the login page click 'Set up your account'.
- Enter your registration number exactly as issued by the school.
- Create a strong password (minimum 8 characters, mix of letters and numbers).
- Confirm the password and submit. You will be redirected to the login screen.
- Use your registration number + new password to sign in.

Each registration number can only be claimed once. If your number is already claimed and you did not do it, contact the administrator immediately.

3. Student Portal

Dashboard

On login, students see a personalised dashboard with quick links to Payments, Timetable, Courses, Announcements, Fees & Requirements and the School Shop.

Payments

- View all payments recorded against your account.
- See running balance, total paid and amount outstanding.
- Download / reprint your receipts (with QR verification code).
- Initiate online payments via EcoCash or Visa where enabled (Paynow Zimbabwe).

Timetable

View your personal class timetable, generated from the school's master timetable. Days, periods, subjects, teachers and rooms are listed clearly.

Courses / Subjects

See subjects assigned to your class/stream. For Forms 5-6 this reflects your Sciences, Commercials or Arts stream selection.

Announcements

Read messages from the school targeted at your role, class or the entire student body. New announcements are highlighted at the top.

Fees & Requirements

See the fees applicable to your form/stream, broken down by category (tuition, levies, uniform, books, etc.). Beginners and returning students may see different requirements.

School Shop

Browse stationery, uniforms and other items available from the school. Items are linked to inventory and updated in real time.

4. Teacher Portal

Teacher Dashboard

Teachers see their daily schedule, classes they teach and quick links to attendance and the class roster.

Class Roster

- Filter by Form and Stream to view enrolled students.
- See basic profile info (registration number, gender, guardian contact).
- Use the roster as the starting point for marking attendance.

Attendance

- Pick the class and date.
- Mark each student Present, Absent or Late.
- Optional notes per student. Save to commit; entries are audited.

- Historical attendance can be reviewed and edited within policy windows.

My Timetable

Personalised view of the master timetable filtered to the teacher's subjects and classes, with rooms and periods clearly marked.

5. Admin Portal Overview

Admins (and staff with admin-equivalent roles such as Cashier and Timetable Manager) have access to the full management suite. Some sensitive areas (e.g. Audit Trail, Settings) are protected by a 4-digit PIN.

Sidebar Modules

- Dashboard - KPIs, live charts and shortcuts.
- Students - register, edit, photo, ID cards, bulk import.
- Payments - record cash/bank/online payments, OCR scan, receipts.
- Fees - manage fee requirements per form, stream and gender.
- Subjects / Teachers / Classes - academic structure.
- Class Roster & Attendance - oversight across all classes.
- Timetable & Master Timetable - generate and publish schedules.
- Announcements - broadcast messages and SMS.
- Inventory & School Shop - uniforms, books, stationery sales.
- Procurement - requisitions, purchase orders, GRN.
- Reports & Audit Trail - exports and full activity log.
- Settings - school info, security, integrations.

6. Student Management

Registering a Student

- Click 'Add Student' and fill first name, last name, form, stream and gender.
- Registration number is auto-generated as 6 characters (letter-4 digits-letter).
- You may type a custom registration number if needed; duplicates are blocked.
- Set Beginner / Returning to control which fee items apply.
- Optionally capture guardian name and +263 phone for SMS notifications.

Bulk Import (AI OCR)

- Upload a list / photo / PDF; Gemini AI extracts names, forms and streams.
- Review the extracted rows and confirm before saving.
- All new students default to unclaimed; they self-claim on first login.

Student ID Cards

- Capture or upload a student photo to the student-photos bucket.

- Print a single ID card in ISO ID-1 format or bulk-print an entire class.
- Cards include school branding, photo, name, reg number and class.

Editing & Status

- Edit any profile field; balance and payment status are computed automatically.
- Reset a student password if they are locked out (admin-only action, audited).
- Deactivate a student to hide them from active lists without losing history.

7. Payments & Receipts

Recording a Payment

- Search a student by name or registration number.
- Enter amount, currency, method (Cash, Bank Deposit, EcoCash, Visa, Paynow).
- For bank deposits, attach the deposit slip; OCR extracts amount and reference.
- Confirm and submit; a receipt number (RCP-####) is generated automatically.

Bulk Statement Scanning

- Upload a bank statement (PDF or image).
- The AI reads the table: Posting Date, Description, Debit, Credit, Balance.
- Each row is parsed as a block: the date and credit amount sit on the top row; the student name sits on the line directly below.
- Rows where the credit column is empty, or where no student name appears below the date, are skipped.
- Review the suggestions and click Save to post the matched payments.

Receipts

- A4 receipt - full letterhead, suitable for filing.
- 80mm thermal receipt - for the cashier's till printer.
- Each receipt carries a QR code linking to /verify for tamper-proof verification.

Online Payments (Paynow Zimbabwe)

Students can initiate EcoCash or Visa payments from the Student Portal. The Paynow callback updates the payment record automatically once funds clear.

Per-Class Paid vs Unpaid

Open the 'Fees By Class' report inside Payments to see, for each Form & Stream, who has fully paid and who has an outstanding balance. Export to PDF for staff meetings.

8. Fees & Requirements

Defining Requirements

- Create items under categories: fees, uniforms, books, stationery.

- Target by Form (1-6), Stream (G1, G2, G22, Blue, Sciences, Commercials, Arts), and Gender.
- Mark beginner_only or returning_only when an item applies to one group.
- Set sort order and active/inactive status.

How Totals Are Computed

The system sums active items that match the student's Form, Stream, Gender and Beginner status. Payments are summed separately. Balance = Total Paid - Total Fees. Status is one of: No Fees, Outstanding, Paid in Full, Overpaid.

9. Subjects, Teachers & Classes

- Subjects - maintain the master list per form and stream.
- Teachers - manage staff records and subject assignments.
- Classes - configure rooms, capacities and form-stream mappings.

These three modules feed the timetable generator and the class roster.

10. Class Roster & Attendance

- Admins can view all class rosters and override attendance records.
- Teachers see only their assigned classes.
- Attendance records are stored per student per date with audit metadata.
- Reports can be exported by class, date range or individual student.

11. Timetable & Master Timetable

Generating

- Provide subjects, teachers, rooms and class lists.
- The AI scheduler proposes a conflict-free timetable.
- Review and adjust slots using the slot editor.
- Publish to make the timetable visible to students and teachers.

Master View & Export

The master timetable shows every class side-by-side. Export to A3 landscape PDF for the staff room noticeboard.

12. Announcements & Notifications

- Compose a title and body, choose priority (low, normal, high, urgent).
- Target all users or a specific role (student, teacher, admin, owner).
- Optionally send the same content as SMS via Pingram (numbers in +263 format).
- Announcements appear in-app and on each role's dashboard.

13. Inventory & School Shop

- Maintain stock items with price, currency and low-stock threshold.
- Link an inventory item to a fee requirement to enforce consistent pricing.
- Students browse the catalog; admins record sales (cash or charged to fees).
- Stock is decremented automatically when a sale is marked paid.
- An INV-#### receipt is generated for every sale.

14. Procurement (Requisitions & GRN)

Requisitions

- Department raises a request (REQ-####) with items and estimated cost.
- Admin approves; the requisition can be converted to a purchase order.

Purchase Orders

- Issue a PO (PO-####) to a supplier with line items, currency and expected delivery.
- Track status: issued, in transit, delivered, closed.

Goods Received Notes

- Record receipt against a PO with quantities and totals.
- Upload supplier receipts to the grn-receipts bucket for audit.
- GRN numbers (GRN-####) link back to the originating PO.

15. Reports & Audit Trail

- Dashboard charts - revenue, collections, enrolment, attendance.
- Fees by Class - paid vs unpaid breakdown per Form & Stream.
- Payments report - filter by date, method, cashier, status.
- Inventory report - sales, stock movements, low-stock alerts.
- Audit Trail - every payment create / update / void / refund is logged with actor, IP and timestamp.
- Activity Log - login events and sensitive admin actions.

Reports export to PDF (branded) and CSV. The audit trail is read-only and PIN-protected.

16. Owner Dashboard

- Read-only oversight across the entire school.
- See all payments, profiles, inventory, attendance and audit log.
- Designed for leadership review without risk of accidental edits.

17. Security, PIN & Roles

- Roles: admin, cashier, timetable_manager, teacher, student, owner.
- Row-Level Security on every table enforces who can see and edit what.
- Sensitive admin areas require a 4-digit PIN gate on top of the login.
- Idle sessions in admin areas are timed out automatically.
- Passwords are stored hashed by the auth provider; admins can reset them only via the admin tool.
- All payment changes are written to an immutable payment_audit_log.

18. Troubleshooting & Support

Common Issues

- Cannot log in - check Caps Lock and that the registration number is correct (6 characters).
- Account already claimed - contact the administrator; do not attempt to re-claim.
- Payment not showing - confirm status is 'paid'; pending Paynow payments update on callback.
- OCR misread - edit the row manually before saving; the AI is a helper, not a replacement.
- Locked out of admin PIN - the Owner / lead administrator can reset it.

Getting Help

Speak to your school administrator first. For technical issues that the admin cannot resolve, contact the system engineer (see section 19).

19. About the Engineer

Connect Hub was designed, built and is maintained by **Takudzwa 'Harry' Singo**, a 29-year-old software engineer based in Mkoba 6, Gweru, Zimbabwe. Harry combines a deep love for clean, human-centred software with practical knowledge of how Zimbabwean schools actually run - cash deposits, bank statements, parent communication on +263 numbers, and the day-to-day reality of running a campus on tight resources.

His work on Connect Hub focuses on three things: **security** (PIN gates, RLS, audit trails), **speed** (a single page app that loads in seconds even on slow networks) and **practicality** (bulk OCR for statements, ID cards in ISO ID-1, A3 timetables that actually fit the staff room noticeboard).

Contact

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For	Bugs, feature requests, training, system extensions

When reporting an issue, please include: your role, the page you were on, what you tried, what happened, and a screenshot if possible. The faster Harry can reproduce it, the faster it is fixed.

Built with care in Gweru. Thank you for using Connect Hub.